Nasal problems	Nasal hygiene
2. Irritation of nasal mucosa can cause swelling leading to obstruction.	• The nose is in constant contact with allergens (mites, pollen, and mould). Some people develop allergic reactions accompanied by nasal congestion and sneezing. In addition to reduce the symptoms, the use of saline water eliminates allergens found in the mucous membrane.

5.7.4 Other methods of maintaining nasal hygiene are as follows.

1. Use petroleum jelly or vaseline. It canbe applied gently to each nostril 3-2 times a day to promote moisturization of the nose. Triple antibiotic ointment such as Neosporin or Bacitracin can also be used.
2. Some nasal saline sprays have additives such as aloe vera and these are helpful.
3. Consider using a humidifier at home. If your nose feels dry and there is frequent nose bleeds, buy a humidifier for your home
4. Avoid excessive manual manipulation of your nose and nostrils. Frequent rubbing of your nostrils and the passing of tissues or fingers in your nostrils may aggravate nasal irritation from dryness and nose bleeds.

5.7.5 Patients who need special care.

1. Patients with nasogastric tube feeding.
2. Patients with the endotracheal tubes.
3. Unconscious patients.

Highlights.

To prevent reintroducing bacteria back into your nose, keep your irrigation equipment clean and dry between uses. Throw away and replace reusable irrigation equipment **every 3 weeks**.

Fact

In women, nose grows until the age of 15 to 17 and for men, it is 17 to 19.

5.8 CARE OF THE EARS

5.8.1 Introduction

Hygiene of the ears has implications for hearing acuit ywhen wax or foreign substances collect in the external ear canal, and they interfere with sound conduction. Older adults are particularly susceptible to this problem.

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